

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Endpoint Detection and Response | Security Information and Event Management | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of hands-on experience managing and operating enterprise security tooling across large, complex environments. In my current role at the University of the Arts, London, I own the security operations function for an estate of approximately 8,000 users, including the administration of CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR), and the full Microsoft Defender and Microsoft Sentinel stack. I have direct experience managing Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), vulnerability scanning, firewall policy, and email security, as well as leading incident response engagements end-to-end. I bring a pragmatic, delivery-focused approach and thrive in small, high-impact security teams where every engineer is expected to be hands-on across the full security toolset. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Next Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover) - Expert level across console management, detection rule creation and tuning, and host investigation
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; automated playbook creation and alert triage workflows
- **Endpoint and Identity Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access policies, Group Policy, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune across Windows and macOS endpoints
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast (policy management and threat intelligence integration), Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Incident Response:** National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-61 framework; MITRE ATT&CK framework for threat mapping and detection alignment
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell for security automation, endpoint remediation, and reporting
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Centre for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), MITRE ATT&CK
- **Additional Tools:** Tanium, Microsoft Entra Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Splunk (Security Practitioner)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

Leading hands-on security engineering and operations across an 8,000-user estate, owning the full security toolset from Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) through to identity, email security, and vulnerability management.

- Deploy, configure and manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Next Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Falcon Insight, and Falcon Discover; own console administration, detection rule tuning, and host investigation and response actions across the full endpoint estate

- Operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries for threat hunting, detection rule development, and alert triage; manage Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate containment and notification workflows
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender to deliver integrated endpoint and identity protection across cloud and on-premises infrastructure
- Manage Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) enforcement via Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AD) Conditional Access policies, reducing identity-based attack surface
- Administer Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) via Microsoft Intune across Windows and macOS endpoints, enforcing compliance baselines and configuration profiles
- Conduct vulnerability scanning and exposure management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; prioritise and track remediation in collaboration with infrastructure teams using a risk-based approach
- Lead incident response engagements end-to-end using the NIST SP 800-61 framework, including detection, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident reporting
- Protect email infrastructure using Mimecast, including advanced threat protection policy configuration, impersonation controls, and integration with threat intelligence feeds
- Manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, enforcing least-privilege access across administrative and service accounts
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to build organisational resilience and reduce human risk
- Maintain and review firewall policies using Check Point Harmony, conducting periodic access rule reviews and aligning configurations to security standards

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

Delivered security operations and identity management across the UAL estate, supporting deployment of enterprise security tooling and driving improvements to the organisation's detection and response capability.

- Supported deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Sentinel across 8,000 users; wrote KQL detection rules and alert tuning logic to reduce false-positive rates
- Administered Entra ID, Conditional Access, and Azure Active Directory (AD) to enforce identity-based security controls across cloud and hybrid environments
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, prioritising findings by risk and coordinating remediation with system owners
- Conducted threat hunting exercises aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, proactively identifying attacker techniques across endpoint and identity telemetry
- Managed email security using Mimecast, tuning inbound and outbound policies to block phishing, malware, and Business Email Compromise (BEC) attempts
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control elevated access and enforce just-in-time provisioning for administrator accounts
- Supported incident response investigations, triaging security alerts from the SIEM and EDR platforms, containing affected systems, and producing post-incident reports
- Created and delivered security awareness training content; managed phishing simulation programmes to measure and improve staff resilience
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) and ISO 27001 compliance activities, including evidence gathering, control testing, and gap analysis

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained endpoint security controls and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and cloud-first environment
- Managed identity and access controls including Active Directory (AD), Azure AD, and role-based access provisioning and deprovisioning
- Conducted vulnerability scans and coordinated patch management cycles to maintain security baseline compliance

- Supported Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) log ingestion and alert monitoring, escalating incidents per the incident response process
- Administered Mobile Device Management (MDM) solutions and maintained Intune device compliance policies
- Managed network security including firewall rule reviews, Virtual Private Network (VPN) access controls, and endpoint protection policies

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, and Discover across an 8,000-user estate, significantly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for endpoint threats
- Reduced alert triage time by automating Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks for common incident types, freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification, leading technical control testing and evidence collection across the organisation
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full UAL estate, improving visibility into endpoint and identity-based threats
- Built a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), enabling continuous exposure tracking and prioritised remediation
- Designed and delivered a phishing simulation and security awareness training programme that measurably reduced click-through rates across the organisation year-on-year

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)